# Ageing WIP & Service Level Expectation

See how old each open item is compared with how long work usually takes, and act before it's late.

Manage Flow · Work Item Age · Cycle Time Percentiles · Service Level Expectation

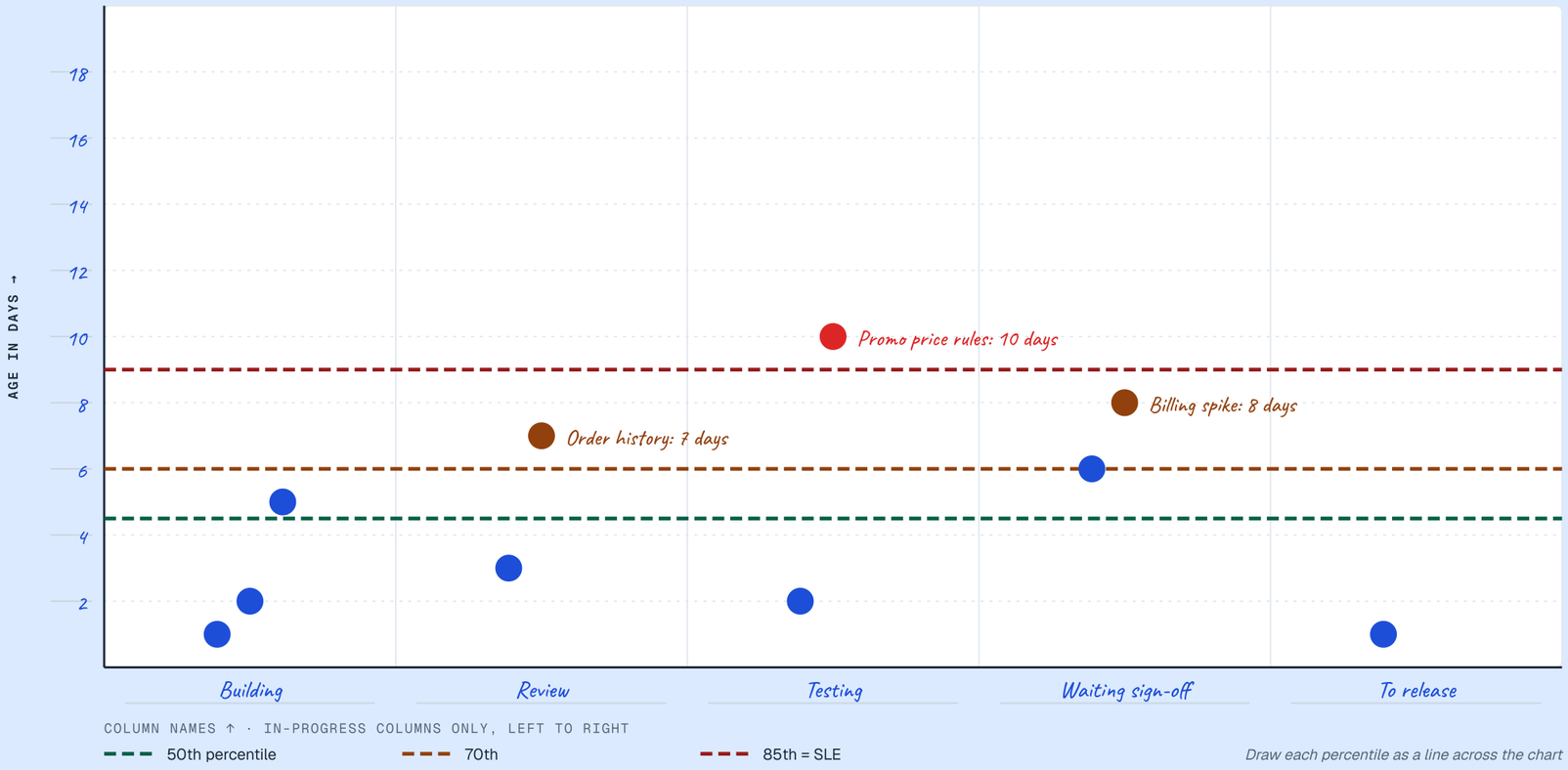
WORKED EXAMPLE · FICTIONAL TEAM

TEAM: Basket team

DATE: 9 May

## 1 Ageing WIP Chart

ONE DOT PER OPEN ITEM, IN ITS CURRENT COLUMN




COLUMN NAMES ↑ · IN-PROGRESS COLUMNS ONLY, LEFT TO RIGHT

50th percentile · 70th · 85th = SLE

*Draw each percentile as a line across the chart*

## 2 Cycle Time Data

RECENTLY FINISHED ITEMS

| ITEM | STARTED | FINISHED | DAYS |
|---|---|---|---|
| Last-order card | 3 Mar | 6 Mar | 3 |
| Reorder button | 5 Mar | 12 Mar | 5 |
| Flag unavailable | 17 Mar | 21 Mar | 4 |
| Email confirmation | 18 Mar | 20 Mar | 2 |
| Reorder events | 24 Mar | 1 Apr | 6 |
| Order history | 31 Mar | 10 Apr | 9 |
| Copy test data | 7 Apr | 10 Apr | 3 |
| Price-change tag | 14 Apr | 18 Apr | 4 |
| Favourites API | 22 Apr | 30 Apr | 7 |
| Out-of-stock rules | 14 Apr | 30 Apr | 12 |

50th percentile (days): 4.5

70th percentile (days): 6

85th percentile (days): 9

## 3 Our Service Level Expectation

A FORECAST FOR ONE ITEM, NOT A TARGET

*85% of our items finish within* 9 *days.*

Based on how many items, from when to when: the last 10, March to April

The clock starts when: someone pulls it into Building

The clock stops when: it's released to customers

## 4 Act on Ageing Items

LOOK AT THE OLDEST ITEMS FIRST, EVERY DAY

| | |
|---|---|
| **Past the 50th** | Mention it at the daily sync |
| **Past the 70th** | Ask what's needed to finish it |
| **Past the 85th** | Swarm it (see Buffering & Swarming) |

**Items to act on today:**

- Promo price rules, 10 days: swarm it today
- Billing spike, 8 days: what's needed to finish?
- Order history, 7 days: ask at the sync

*"Which item is oldest, and what would it take to finish it today?"*

*"How long does work usually take here, really?"*

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